11-10 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） Old Zhou, the Librarian Who Repairs Broken Books

① In the back corner of the Sunshine Community Library, behind three tall shelves of geography books, sits a small wooden desk. On the desk there are always the same things: a silver ruler, a roll of soft cotton thread, three small glass jars of wheat-starch glue, a bent metal clip, and a short row of **books with torn spines waiting quietly in a line**. Behind the desk sits **Old Zhou**, the library repairman, aged sixty-two, thin, quiet, and — according to every child in our community — the man who can make old books young again.

② I first met Old Zhou in Grade 6. I had borrowed a dog-eared copy of *Charlotte's Web* and had, very foolishly, **dropped it into a puddle** on the way home. The pages had dried wavy, the cover half-peeled, and the spine cracked down the middle. I was sure I would be fined. When I returned the book with a red face, the young front-desk teacher raised an eyebrow and said, "Go speak to Old Zhou at the back."

③ I carried the book around the tall shelves and found him under a yellow lamp, bent over a 1983 history book. He took my sad, wet *Charlotte's Web* with both hands, as if it were a small bird. He said nothing for almost a minute. Then, without looking up, he said quietly: "A book is like a person. A mistake is not yet the end. Come back on Saturday."

④ When I came back that Saturday, my book was waiting for me on the desk. The cover had been gently flattened. The spine had been **re-sewn with soft cotton thread**. The wavy pages were still slightly wavy, but they had been pressed under weights for three days and were mostly flat again. A small neat strip of white paper now ran along the inside of the spine, holding it strong. On the first blank page, Old Zhou had written, in small, steady letters: "*Repaired on 12 November 2025. Please read more gently this time. — Z.*"

⑤ From that Saturday, I became a small, quiet volunteer at his back-corner desk. Every Sunday afternoon at 15:00, I would sit on the small wooden stool opposite him, my homework finished, my hands washed. He taught me how to **fold the torn corner of a page along the old crease**, how to **dab glue with a bamboo stick — never a brush — so the paper does not wrinkle**, how to press a thin strip of rice paper inside a broken spine, how to listen for the small "**pop**" a book makes when you have glued it back correctly.

⑥ Old Zhou almost never spoke about himself. Once, over a quiet cup of tea, he said only this: when he was young, he had **lost many books in a single afternoon** — a long, painful story he did not finish. From that year on, he had promised himself that **every**

book that came to his desk would leave it in one piece. That was his thirty-seventh year of keeping the promise. "In the end," he said, closing the jar of glue, "a library is not a building. A library is **a thousand small promises to the future**."

⑦ On the wall above his desk Old Zhou had pinned four handwritten cards, with four simple rules in black ink:

1. **A torn page is a gentle request, not a crime.**
2. **Glue is patient. Do not hurry.**
3. **Sew before you glue, if the spine is weak.**
4. **Leave each book in slightly better shape than you found it — so will you leave each day.**

⑧ Old Zhou is retiring at the end of this December. The community has asked me — together with four other volunteers — to be his "small team" that keeps the back-corner desk alive. I am scared. I am slow. My cotton thread is often uneven. But on my last Sunday of practice, Old Zhou slid a yellow Post-it note towards me across the desk. On it he had written, in the same small, steady letters as three years before: "*You learned quietly. That is the hardest part.*" I put the note inside my pencil case and closed it gently. A small promise to the future had, at last, been passed to me.

注释： librarian 图书管理员；spine（书）书脊；starch glue 淀粉胶；crease 折痕；promise 承诺

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What happened to the writer's copy of *Charlotte's Web* in Paragraph ②?

A. She lost it on the bus.
B. She dropped it into a puddle; the pages dried wavy, the cover half-peeled, and the spine cracked down the middle.
C. A younger sister cut its pages.
D. A dog ate it.

2. What did Old Zhou do for the book by the next Saturday?

A. He threw it away and gave the writer a new book.
B. He gently flattened the cover, re-sewed the spine with soft cotton thread, pressed the wavy pages flat under weights for three days, and added a small neat strip of white paper inside the spine.
C. He simply dried the book in the sun.
D. He fined the writer 20 yuan.

3. What skills did Old Zhou teach the writer at the back-corner desk?

A. Folding a torn page along the old crease; dabbing glue with a bamboo stick, never a brush, so the paper does not wrinkle; pressing thin rice paper inside a broken spine; and listening for the small "pop" of a correctly glued book.
B. How to rebind a whole new book.
C. How to write a novel.
D. How to sell old books.

4. Which of the following is NOT one of Old Zhou's four handwritten rules?

A. A torn page is a gentle request, not a crime.
B. Glue is patient. Do not hurry.
C. Sew before you glue, if the spine is weak.
D. Always use a brush, never a bamboo stick.

5. What does Old Zhou's Post-it note "You learned quietly. That is the hardest part." mean to the writer?

A. The writer needs to speak more loudly.
B. It is a warm, quiet sign that Old Zhou is passing the responsibility of his repair desk to the writer, recognising the quiet, patient attitude she has built over three years.
C. The writer should leave the library.
D. The Post-it is only a random piece of paper.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "dropped it into a puddle ... wavy ... cover half-peeled ... spine cracked"
【解析】情节细节直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段维修过程
【解析】四项处理均直引文本。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段技能列表
【解析】修书学徒细节直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

4.
【答案】D

【题型】细节理解题（否定）
【定位】第⑦段四条规则与第⑤段"bamboo stick — never a brush"
【解析】A、B、C 均为规则；D 与其教学相反。故选 D。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑧段结尾
【解析】传承的象征。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。